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TRANSPORTATION



Rivian taps Google to  
bring custom maps into  
its EVs and app

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its existing in-car navigation. Instead, it started working with Google to launch a new product.

Rivian's challenge: It didn't just want the default Google Maps application.

"Google really wanted to embrace a new model of collaboration with a more open integration down to the API levels for Google Maps, and that required working with a tech partner on that journey to integrate both solutions, and I think we're really super happy with the result of this collaboration," he said.

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The new maps feature will include estimated time of arrival, traffic updates, place information, and satellite imagery from Google Maps, all of which is integrated into Rivian's navigation system. The in-car navigation will also include tappable points of interest.

Carrying over Rivian's trip planner is crucial as it showcases EV range estimates and charging stop

selection, all powered by [A Better Routeplanner](#). Other Rivian features like its “range on arrival,” charging stops and preferences, and the EV maker’s charging score, which gives a rating for individual charging sites based on plug-in data from Rivian vehicles, have also been folded into Google Maps.

The new Google-based maps will start to roll out today via a software update in Rivian vehicles and its mobile app.

The updated Rivian mobile app will include additional trip planning features as well. Rivian said it added place photos, place descriptions, and satellite imagery to the app. Rivian also added well as... in the app... destinations... their ve...

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Rivian is turning on the first EV fast chargers in its adventure network

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base.

The first Level 3 DC fast charging site, which opened Monday in Salida, Colorado, has four chargers that can provide more than 200 kilowatts of power, [according to Rivian](#). This allows Rivian R1T drivers (and eventually R1S SUV drivers) to add as much as 140 miles of range in 20 minutes, the company said. One of the fast chargers is set up as a pull-through site to accommodate vehicles towing trailers.

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Rivian said its second and third Adventure Network sites will open June 28 and June 29 in Inyokern and Bishop, California, locations that are near several recreational destinations such as Mammoth Lakes, Yosemite National Park and Death Valley National Park.

Opening the three DC fast charging sites is an important and first step toward Rivian's plan to install 3,500 fast chargers at 600 sites across North America. But these fast chargers are just one piece of Rivian's dual EV infrastructure strategy to [install more than 10,000 chargers](#) by the end of 2023.

The Rivian fast charger opened in the E

Rivian is installing fast chargers for its electric bike and scooter and standard EVs. The aim is to create a base around which Rivian's ecosystem has dual

accessible to all electric vehicle brands with a J1772 plug. The DC fast chargers are only accessible to Rivian customers.

Rivian started last July to install the first of these waypoints at all 42 Colorado state parks. Each park will have two Rivian waypoints each.

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TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

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agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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IMAGE CREDITS: RIVIAN

Rivian, the EV startup [backed by Amazon](#), Cox Automotive and T. Rowe Price, plans to install more than 10,000 chargers by the end of 2023. The network will have a dual purpose: quickly power its electric vehicle models with fast chargers installed along highways and provide Level 2 chargers at further afield locations next to parks, trailheads and other adventurous destinations.

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The company said Thursday that its so-called Rivian Adventure Network will include more than 3,500 DC fast chargers at over 600 sites, which will only be accessible to owners of its electric vehicles. Each site will have multiple chargers and located on highways and main roads, often by cafes and shops, the company said in a blog post Thursday.

Rivian is also installing thousands of “waypoint” Level 2 AC chargers throughout the United States and Canada. These waypoint chargers will have a 11.5 kW charging speed, which should be able add up to 25 miles of range every hour for its R1T pickup truck and R1S SUV. The waypoint chargers will be strategically located along and near routes that

Rivian co-founders found a campsite which was all electric being installed

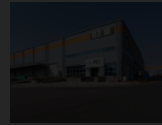
The decision vehicle customer confidence

general, Rivian founder and CEO RJ Scaringe [told TechCrunch](#) late last year during a wide-ranging interview about charging, batteries and automated driving.

Rivian’s approach is similar to Tesla with a few distinct differences. Tesla has built a proprietary network of more than 20,000 Superchargers, which are typically located next to highways and busy commuter corridors, and destination chargers installed at high-end hotels, restaurants and other spots an owner of a Model 3, Model S, Model Y or Model X might visit.

Kirsten Korosec  
- 15 hours ago

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Rivian's waypoint chargers serve the same purpose — albeit different kinds of locations — to the Tesla destination chargers. However, unlike Tesla's chargers, Rivian's waypoint sites are open to the public and use the J1772 plug, a North American standard for electrical connectors for electric vehicles.

As part of its announcement, Rivian shared an image of a map of its fast chargers, indicating where they will be located. The map is not yet interactive, making it difficult to provide exact locations, but it appears that there are fast chargers located near Grand Canyon National Park as well as Zion National Park in Utah.

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IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT/RIVIAN

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Management and Research Company, Amazon's Climate Pledge Fund, Coatue and D1 Capital Partners as well as several other existing and new investors also participated, which pushed Rivian's valuation to \$27.6 billion, according to a person familiar with the investment round.

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